

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 8 6 4

♥ 10 9

♦ 5

♣ A J 8 4 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K Q J 7 5 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 6 5



♠ Q 3

♥ 4

♦ K 9 8 6 4 3

♣ K Q 9 7

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ A 10 2

♣ 10 3

West

1 ♠

All Pass

3 ♥ by North

Lead: ♣K

North

2 ♥

East

Pass

South

3 ♥

The bidding has been as shown.

You overcall 2 ♥ and hear partner raise you to 3 ♥.

No matter how many times you check this hand you cannot revalue it any more than 13 points. Since partner has 10 at the most you reluctantly pass.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ Q 6 5
♦ K J 6 2
♣ J 6 5 4

♠ J 8 3

♥ A J 9 2

♦ 10 7

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

2♠

1♦

1♠

All Pass

2♠ by South

Lead: ♠10

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 7
 ♥ J 8 5
 ♦ A Q 7 4
 ♣ 10 7 5 4

♠ Q J 10 9 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2



♠ 6 5

♥ 10 7 6 2

♦ K J 9 2

♣ A J 6

♠ K 8 4 2

♥ A 9 3

♦ 10 5

♣ K Q 9 3

West

1 ♦

North

1 ♠

East

Pass

South

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown.

You have enough for a 1-level Overcall so you bid 1 ♠. Partner says 3 ♠.

The jump raise tells you partner has 11-14 points.

With your minimum it's going to have to be better than that to get you excited. So you pass.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ J 10 6 4
♦ K Q 10 7 4
♣ 10 6

♠ K 8 7 5 3

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A

♣ 7 5 4 3



♠ 10
♥ A K Q 9 8
♦ J 5 3
♣ A K Q 9

♠ A Q J 6 4

♥ 3

♦ 9 8 6 2

♣ J 8 2

*West**North**East**South*

3♥

4♠

1♥

1♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Lead: ♥J

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 10 points, but in cases like this points don't matter that much. They **MIGHT** be able to make 4♥. Partner **MIGHT** be able to make 4♠. This preemptive jump takes the decision away from them.

Looking at the hands you can see that partner is going to go down 1 at 4♠. However, that is an excellent result since they appear to be cold for 5♥.